

[Lesson 14:](#) The Law of Consecration (See [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand the law of consecration and its eternal purposes and to help us desire to consecrate our lives more fully to the service of God. †1. The Prophet Joseph Smith

1. The Lord revealed the law of consecration to the Saints.

- D&C 42:30-42 What were the purposes of this law?

Consecrating Possessions

- D&C 42:30. “Church members voluntarily consecrated their possessions to the Church by legal deed.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Receiving a Stewardship

- D&C 42:32; 51:3. The “bishop granted them stewardships, or portions, from all the properties received, according to the circumstances and needs of the family, as determined by the bishop in consultation with the member who received it.”
- D&C 51:4; 72:3-4; 104:11-13. “The stewardship was given with a deed of ownership so each member would be fully responsible and accountable for managing it... The stewardship then, was treated as private property, not common or communal property, recognizing that all property belongs to God.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Surpluses

- D&C 42:33; 51:13. “If members produced a surplus from their stewardships beyond what was necessary for their families, at the end of the year they gave it to the bishop to put in the bishop’s storehouse... (*Lesson Manual*)
- D&C 42:34-35. “The bishop used the surplus to care for the poor, to build houses of worship, and for other worthy purposes...” (*Lesson Manual*)

United Order

- D&C 78:3. “In March 1832, the Lord revealed that there must be an organization to regulate and administer the law of consecration among His people...” (*Lesson Manual*)
- D&C 92:1. “He called this organization the “united order”... (*Lesson Manual*)
- D&C 104. “In subsequent revelations the Lord gave further instructions concerning the united order...” (*LM*)

2. The law of consecration is an eternal law.

- Moses 7:18. (The people of Enoch).
- Acts 4:32, 34-35. (The Saints after the Savior’s Resurrection).
- 4 Nephi 1:1-3, 23-24, 15. (The Nephites after the Savior’s visit to them).

What might be some of the blessings of living in such a community?

3. We can consecrate our lives to the Lord now.

As we practice living the law of consecration today, we are preparing to live the fullness of the law when it’s required.

What are some ways we might practice the law of consecration?

Realize that everything we have belongs to the Lord.

Psalms 24:1; D&C 104:13-14; †2. Bishop Victor L. Brown

Make the sacrifices the Lord requires now. †3. President Spencer W. Kimball

1. Pay tithing and fast offerings, and give generously in other ways to those in need. †4. Elder Marion G. Romney
2. Serve willingly in the Church (D&C 107:99-100).
3. Serve as a full-time missionary. †5. Elder Robert D. Hales

Develop Christlike love for others.

- D&C 82:19; Jacob 2:17

What are some ways that this attribute is crucial to the law of consecration?

Strive to consecrate all aspects of our lives to the Lord.

†6. President Thomas S. Monson †7. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

What may be some ways we are “keeping back part”?

Next Week: Lesson 15: “Seek Ye Earnestly the Best Gifts”; See L15 [Class Member Study Guide](#). † •
(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).)

†1. **The Prophet Joseph Smith:** “A religion that does not require the sacrifice of all things never has power sufficient to produce the faith necessary unto life and salvation; for, from the first existence of man, the faith necessary unto the enjoyment of life and salvation never could be obtained without the sacrifice of all earthly things....” (*Lectures on Faith*, 6:7)

†2. **Bishop Victor L. Brown** (former Presiding Bishop of the Church) said that until we “feel in total harmony” with the principle that everything belongs to the Lord, “it will be difficult, if not impossible, for us to accept the law of consecration. As we prepare to live this law, we will look forward with great anticipation to the day when the call will come. If, on the other hand, we hope it can be delayed so we can have the pleasure of accumulating material things, we are on the wrong path.” (*1976 Devotional Speeches of the Year*, 439)

†3. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “Consecration is the giving of one’s time, talents, and means to care for those in need—whether spiritually or temporally—and in building the Lord’s kingdom. In Welfare Services, members consecrate as they labor on production projects, donate materials to Deseret Industries, share their professional talents, give a generous fast offering, and respond to ward and quorum service projects. They consecrate their time in their home or visiting teaching. We consecrate when we give of ourselves.” (“[And the Lord Called His People Zion](#),” *Ensign*, Aug 1984, 4)

†4. **Elder Marion G. Romney:** “What prohibits us from giving as much in fast offerings as we would have given in surpluses under the United Order? Nothing but our own limitations.” (*Conference Report*, Apr 1966)

†5. **Elder Robert D. Hales:** “Going on a mission teaches you to live the law of consecration. It may be the only time in your life when you can give to the Lord all your time, talents, and resources. In return, the Lord will bless you with His Spirit to be with you. He will be close to you and strengthen you.” (“[If Thou Wilt Enter into Life, Keep the Commandments](#),” *Ensign*, May 1996, 36)

†6. **President Thomas S. Monson:** “I have many memories of my boyhood. Anticipating Sunday dinner was one of them. Just as we children ... sat anxiously at the table, with the aroma of roast beef filling the room, Mother would say to me, ‘Tommy, before we eat, take this plate I’ve prepared down the street to Old Bob and hurry back.’

“I could never understand why we couldn’t first eat and later deliver his plate of food. I never questioned aloud but would run down to his house and then wait anxiously as Bob’s aged feet brought him eventually to the door. Then I would hand him the plate of food. He would present to me the clean plate from the previous Sunday and offer me a dime as pay for my services. My answer was always the same: ‘I can’t accept the money. My mother would tan my hide.’ He would then run his wrinkled hand through my blond hair and say, ‘My boy, you have a wonderful mother. Tell her thank you.’ ... Sunday dinner always seemed to taste a bit better after I had returned from my errand.” (“[The Long Line of the Lonely](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 1992, 4)

†7. **Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** “The submission of one’s will is really the only uniquely personal thing we have to place on God’s altar. The many other things we ‘give’ ... are actually the things He has already given or loaned to us. However, when you and I finally submit ourselves, by letting our individual wills be swallowed up in God’s will, then we are really giving something to Him! It is the only possession which is truly ours to give!” (“[Swallowed Up in the Will of the Father](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 24)

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder D. Todd Christofferson, “[Reflections on a Consecrated Life](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 2010, 16-19.
2. President Spencer W. Kimball, “[And the Lord Called His People Zion](#),” *Ensign*, Aug. 1984, 4.
3. Elder Neal A. Maxwell, “[Swallowed Up in the Will of the Father](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 24.
4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie, “[Obedience, Consecration, and Sacrifice](#),” *Ensign*, May 1975, 50.

Visit stephenmbird.com

Further Enrichment Resources:

Other Practices that Prepare Us for the Law of Consecration:

Learn to Be Grateful for What We Have.

Elder D. Todd Christofferson told of Elder Marcus B. Nash's interview with Pamela Conde, wife of Peruvian Branch President Wenceslao Conde, following a massive earthquake in 2007.

"Elder Nash asked Sister Conde how her children were. With a smile, she replied that through the goodness of God they were all safe and well. He asked about the Condes' home.

"It's gone," she said simply.

"What about your belongings?" he inquired.

"Everything was buried in the rubble of our home," Sister Conde replied.

"And yet," Elder Nash noted, "you are smiling as we talk."

"Yes," she said, "I have prayed and I am at peace. We have all we need. We have each other, we have our children, we are sealed in the temple, we have this marvelous Church, and we have the Lord. We can build again with the Lord's help." ("[The Power of Covenants](#)," *Ensign*, May 2009, 19-23)

Repent of Envy and Coveting Others, their Lives, and Possessions. Get Out of Debt, so We Can Give Generously to the Poor.

Elder Robert D. Hales: "Being provident providers, we must obey that most basic commandment, 'Thou shalt not covet.' (Exodus 2:17) Our world is fraught with feelings of entitlement... As a result we go into debt; buy things we can't afford, and things we do not really need. Whenever we do this we become poor temporally and spiritually. We give away some of our precious, priceless agency and put ourselves in self-imposed servitude. Money we could have used to care for others must now be used to pay for debt..." ("[Becoming Provident Providers Temporally and Spiritually](#)," *Ensign*, May 2009, 7-10)

Keep God's Commandments as Well as We Can.

Elder Bruce R. McConkie: "How, for instance, can we establish our ability to live the full law of consecration if we do not in fact pay an honest tithing? Or how can we prove our willingness to sacrifice all things, if need be, if we do not make the small sacrifices of time and toil, or of money and means, that we are now asked to make?"

"As a young man, serving at the direction of my bishop, I called upon a rich man and invited him to contribute a thousand dollars to a building fund. He declined. But he did say he wanted to help, and if we

would have a ward dinner and charge \$5 per plate, he would take two tickets. [About ten days later this man died unexpectedly of a heart attack](#), and I have wondered ever since about the fate of his eternal soul." ("[Obedience, Consecration, and Sacrifice](#)," *Ensign*, May 1975, 50.

Attend the Temple Frequently and Regularly.

Elder Richard G. Scott: "Fourteen years ago I decided to attend the temple and complete an ordinance at least once a week. When I am traveling I make up the missed visits... I have kept that resolve, and [it has changed my life profoundly](#)."

"I would like to relate the experience of an ancestor of my wife, Jeanene. Her name is Sarah DeArmon Pea Rich. Her commentary shows the impact that the temple can have in our lives. When she was 31 years old, she received a calling from Brigham Young to work in the Nauvoo Temple, where all the ordinances possible were performed before the Saints had to abandon that temple. This is what she wrote:

"Many were the blessings we had received in the house of the Lord, which has caused us joy and comfort in the midst of all our sorrows and enabled us to have faith in God, knowing He would guide us and sustain us in the unknown journey that lay before us. For if it had not been for the faith and knowledge that was bestowed upon us in that temple by the influence and help of the Spirit of the Lord, our journey would have been like one taking a leap in the dark. To start out on such a journey in the winter as it were and in our state of poverty, it would seem like walking into the jaws of death. But we had faith in our Heavenly Father, and we put our trust in Him feeling that we were His chosen people and had embraced His gospel, and instead of sorrow, we felt to rejoice that the day of our deliverance had come." ("[Temple Worship: The Source of Strength and Power in Times of Need](#)," *Ensign*, May 2009, 43-45)